

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-11

Schedule Management Plan

How the schedule will be developed, maintained and controlled

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Schedule Management Plan
Document reference	PMB-11-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-12	Activity and Milestone List	Produced under this plan
PMB-13	Schedule Baseline and Network	Produced under this plan
PMB-28	Work Performance Report	Reports against this plan

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Establishes the criteria and activities for developing, monitoring and controlling the project schedule, including units of measure, level of accuracy, tolerances, control thresholds and the rules of performance measurement.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Schedule Management — Plan Schedule Management
Created when	During planning
Reviewed / updated	Through change control once baselined
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Where delivery is iterative, replace activity-level scheduling with a release and iteration cadence, but keep the milestone commitments and the control thresholds.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Control thresholds are numeric and trigger a defined action
- The scheduling method and tool are named, with the version
- Rules for progress reporting are unambiguous — how percent complete is determined
- Float management and who owns it is stated
- Schedule change control is consistent with the overall change management plan

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1. Scheduling approach

Field	Detail
Scheduling method	<i>e.g. Critical path method</i>
Tool and version	<i>Enterprise scheduling tool — Helios T2 master schedule, v1.0</i>
Level of detail	<i>Work package level for tranche 3, activity level for the current and next quarter</i>
Rolling wave planning?	<i>Yes — activity-level detail is maintained one quarter ahead</i>
Units of measure	<i>e.g. Days</i>
Working calendar	<i>Sunday to Thursday, UAE public holidays, no work during Group financial close</i>
Level of accuracy	<i>–5% to +10% for the current tranche</i>

2. Estimating approach

Technique	When used	Accuracy range	Source of data
Analogous	<i>Used for Tranche 3 order-of-magnitude estimating, based on the Tranche 1 pilot actuals</i>	<i>–5% to +10% for the current tranche</i>	<i>Used for Tranche 3 order-of-magnitude estimating, based on the Tranche 1 pilot actuals</i>
Parametric	<i>Cost per GPU installed, derived from Tranche 1 — AED 44,500 per accelerator all-in</i>	<i>–5% to +10% for the current tranche</i>	<i>Cost per GPU installed, derived from Tranche 1 — AED 44,500 per accelerator all-in</i>
Three-point (PERT)	<i>Applied to the facilities work packages where variability is highest</i>	<i>–5% to +10% for the current tranche</i>	<i>Applied to the facilities work packages where variability is highest</i>
Bottom-up	<i>Used for the Tranche 2 definitive estimate at work package level</i>	<i>–5% to +10% for the current tranche</i>	<i>Used for the Tranche 2 definitive estimate at work package level</i>

3. Control thresholds

Measure	Green	Amber	Red	Action at amber	Action at red
Schedule variance	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level</i>
Schedule performance index	<i>Tranche 2</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completes</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completes</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of</i>

Measure	Green	Amber	Red	Action at amber	Action at red
	completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	+4 weeks at programme level	+4 weeks at programme level
Milestone slip	Confirmed with the FM provider under the existing facilities contract	Owned within WS4 Platform and orchestration	Scoped to the three onboarding tenants: AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail	Enforce mutual TLS on the cluster API and retest by 22 Sep 2026	Enforce mutual TLS on the cluster API and retest by 22 Sep 2026
Critical path float	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the SRO immediately	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the SRO immediately	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the SRO immediately	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the SRO immediately	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the SRO immediately

4. Rules of performance measurement

How progress is claimed. Without a rule here, percent complete becomes an opinion.

Rule	Application
Earned value technique	e.g. 0/100 for work packages under 10 days; milestone weighting above
Percent complete determination	No
Level of effort treatment	Engage vendor performance engineering for two weeks per hall
Control account level	WBS level 1

5. Schedule maintenance

Activity	Frequency	Owner	Output
Progress update	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	18 Sep 2026
Critical path review	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the SRO immediately	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the SRO immediately
Forecast update	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	18 Sep 2026
Baseline comparison	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0

6. Float and reserve management

Who owns total float, and how schedule reserve is held and released.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Delegated to the Programme Manager within the agreed tolerance. Detail is maintained by the Project manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.

7. Reporting formats

Report	Format	Audience	Frequency
ART sync record	Workshop with the affected workstream leads	CISO and Security Architect	Quarterly
Monthly benefit tracking report	Dashboard published to the programme site	Programme Manager and workstream leads	Monthly
Tranche 2 gate evidence pack	Live walkthrough with a recorded session	Programme Board	At each stage boundary
Weekly workstream status return	Written pack circulated 48 hours in advance	Agile Release Train — all teams	Each iteration